

is a bit different and the way by which files are accessed is different than Windows. We'll tell you about this in a while.

Where are the documents?

You must be fond of that old friendly 'My Documents' in Windows. We assume you've also found it inside the user profile folder (some also call it the 'user' folder and has the same name as the user). Assuming Windows is installed on C: drive, its path should be C:\Users\Vaibhav, if the user is named Vaibhav. The same folder should have the sub-folders for music, videos, contacts etc. Linux has a similar approach with a different name. It calls the 'user profile' folder as the 'home' folder. Some might also call it the home directory because the word 'directory' is used instead of 'folder' in Linux world. The path to the home directory would be '/home/vaibhav' if the username is vaibhav. Did we hear you saying 'strange'? We believe we just did. Next up, we'll explain why it is this way. Oh, and we just promised to show how drives are accessed. It's time.

Understanding 'mounting'; the Windows way!

Before we make a statement about how Linux mounts partitions on folders, let's understand mounting. Mounting is the method used to make the contents of some storage media accessible to the computer so that it can be read or written to. While Windows uses 'drive letters' to mount partitions, Linux uses folders. To understand how partitions can be mounted to folders, let's do the following on a Windows system. We assume here that the system has two partitions with drive letters C: and D:

- ▶ Create an empty folder named 'mountpoint' in C: drive.
- ▶ Right-click 'Computer' on the start menu and select 'manage'.
- ▶ On the computer management console that opens, select 'Disk Management' (under 'Storage') from the left pane. This should list down the partitions.
- ▶ Right-click the D: drive and select 'Change Drive letters and paths'.
- ▶ On the new window that opens, click on 'Add...' This will open up another window.
- ▶ Click on the browse button to select the 'mountpoint' folder in C: drive or type the path (C:\mountpoint) in the input box.
- ▶ Confirm this by clicking on the OK buttons on the windows that came up.
- ▶ Wait for a second, and then go to the C:\mountpoint folder (its icon would have changed).